Exam Case #6

CANDIDATE'S INSTRUCTIONS:

A shy, quiet woman approaches you with her eyes to the ground. Assist her in solving her problem. Give her your recommendation as you would in practice.

Time Frame: You have 7 minutes to complete this station.
References: Minor Ailment, Acne

TIPS
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PATIENT RECORD

PATIENT: Farah Patel
ADDRESS: 7900 Pharmacy PREP Ave.
PHONE: 416-223-7737

AGE:18 years old
GENDER: Female
ALLERGIES: None known
Medical conditions:

PHYSICIAN: Dr. S. Mason
ADDRESS: #358-4750 Yonge st. Toronto
PHONE: 647-221-0457

Rx#	Medications-Directions	Qty	Repeats	
			Authorized	Remaining

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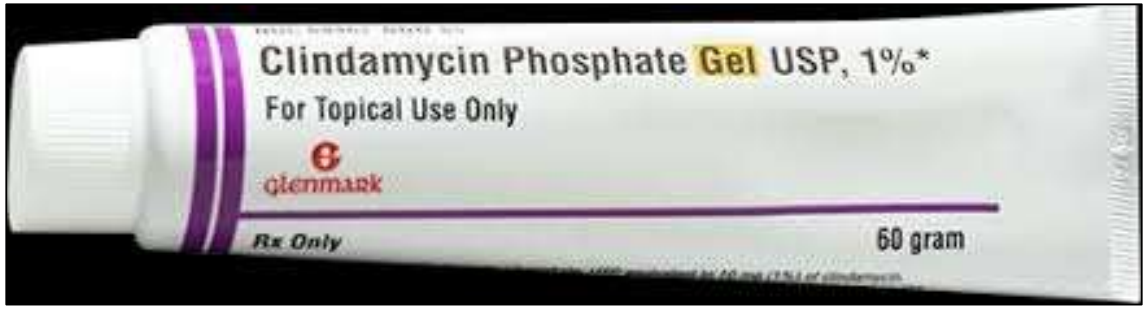

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SP instructions:

•SP is looking shy and at the ground; not keeping eye contact.

•**Opening statement** **“**I’ve been struggling a lot lately, and I really need some help.”

•Upon asking, SP says “I never had this problem before, but lately I’ve been seeing a lot of pimples on my face, it’s making me very self-conscious.”

•**Only if the candidate** asks: “It seems like you may have acne, can you describe your symptoms more?” Say “well mostly just raised bumps on my face, I think they’re called comedones. I think some are red and a bit swollen (i.e., only few papules/pustules).

•I have oily skin.

•Only if asked about history, say: “I think I started to get them the past 1 month and they’re just not going away with my regular washing. I guess I’ve been very stressed at schools because of final exams. I’ve been eating a lot of chocolate and fast food, mostly fried chicken.”

•First time getting it- “maybe when I was 14-15, but it went away.” (i.e. due to hormonal changes)

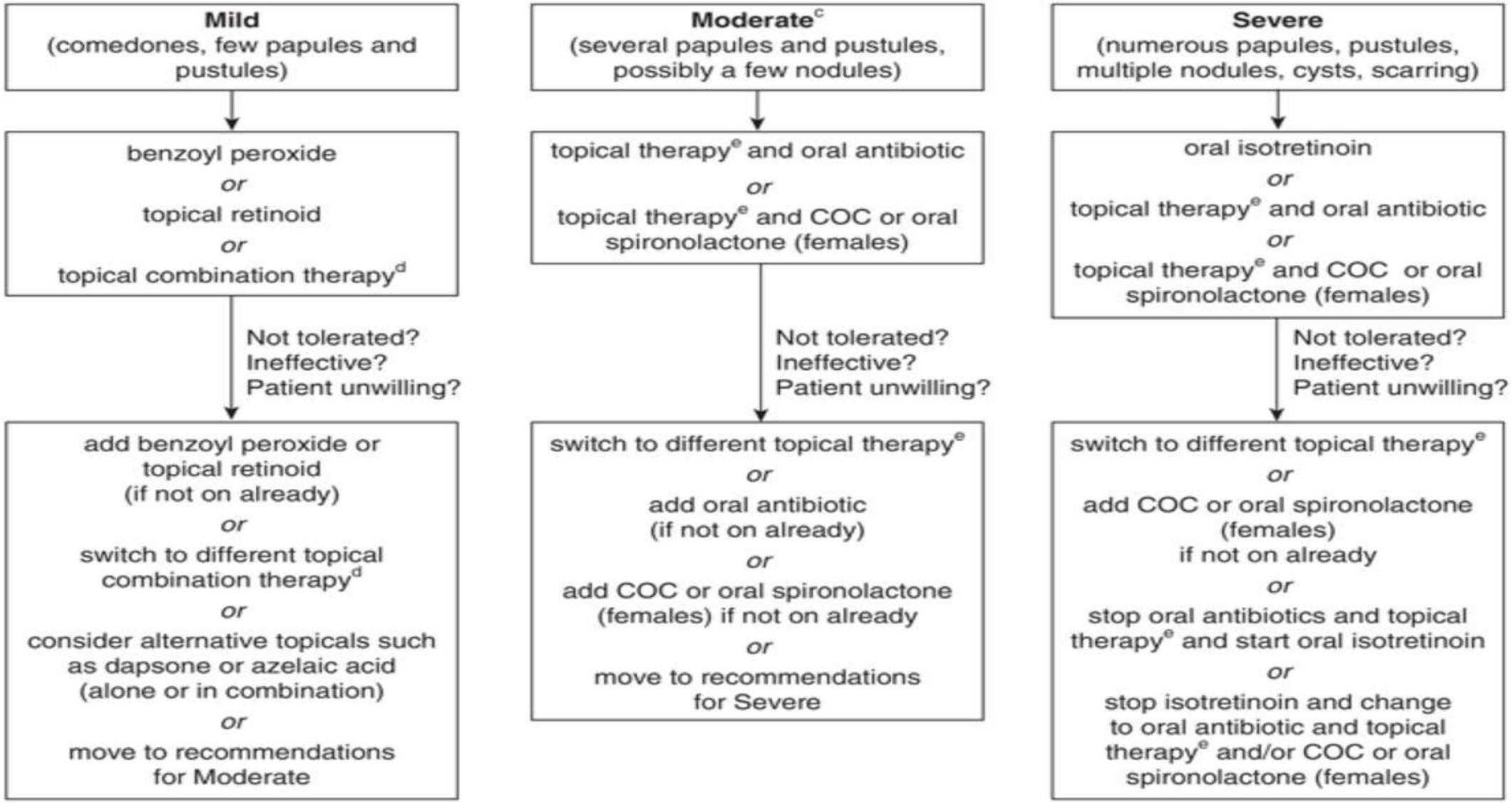
•If candidate asks about the medications, no medications.

•Current face hygiene regimen: “I wash my face in the morning and evening, using my regular, usual sensitive face wash and lotion. I shower daily and have good hygiene overall. Maybe sometimes I pick at the bumps when I’m studying, but that’s ok, right?” → candidate should advise not to.

•Allergies: not know and Medical conditions: none and healthy (young woman)

•If candidate says: “ I request you to go to the doctor”, SP says “My family doctor is very busy, and I cannot get an appointment. Can’t you at least help me for now?”ti

Figure 1: Management of Acne[a][b]



- Profiling of patient- allergies, age, clarifies the presence of comedowns and only a few pustules/papules. No nodules, scarring, or cysts.
- differential diagnosis (rosacea, perioral dermatitis, drug-induced acne), red flags (infection/drug reaction), fungal infection
- suggests: Starting benzoyl peroxide 2.5% or benzoyl peroxide 5% → ***gold standard for <u>MILD</u> acne***
- Counselling for benzoyl peroxide available **cream, lotion and gel**.
- Apply up to 2 times daily. **Apply on to the pimple and surrounding pimple area**
- It is a mild skin irritant and a rare allergen
- **Formulations can bleach clothing.**
- **It is photosensitive so use sunscreen**
- It can take 2–3 months to see significant improvement with the use of topical.
- If no improvement in 2-3 months, please be assessed by the doctor.
- Non-pharm
  - Exercise: reduces stress (acne aggravating factor)
  - Cleaning: Wash face with gentle soapless cleanser no more than twice daily, washing the face too often can dry and irritate skin, making acne worse
- Marginally solved
- differential diagnosis, red flags, fungal infection
- suggests: topical retinoid (Retin-A) –but must clarify Rx will likely be needed or recommends dapsone 5%. **Key:** needs to recognize it is mild acne and patient does not have a history of it; should treat it as mild.

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Pharmacy PREP OSCE Check List Acne

Communication skills (checklist)	Outstanding	Good	Acceptable	NOT Acceptable
Opening Statement (respond to patient clue, good listener, did not interrupt patient, engaging). Non-verbal Skills (eye contact, gesture, posture), Identified patient?	4	3	2	1
Information gathering process. (Asked M-A-M-A) allergies, medicine history, medical conditions. Builds trust and confidence with patient, Specific lifestyle such as alcohol and smoking habits prn; and/or other considerations relevant to the purpose of the case (hygiene, stress, PCOS)	4	3	2	1
Discuss Follow up/Monitoring relevant to case	4	3	2	1
Time to check references, and use of proper references	4	3	2	1
Overall time management	4			
Overall communications	**Outstanding (20)**	**Good (15-20)**	Acceptable (12-14)	**(<14) NOT Acceptable**
Problem Solving (checklist)	Fully solved (FS)	Marginally solved (MS)	Marginally unsolved (MU)	Unsolved (U)
key elements of the counseling task 1. Recognized it is **mild acne;** recommends OTC and provides rationale for OTC recommendation (Benzoyl peroxide 5%; discuss strengths as well – 5% is most usually recommended) 2.Non pharms for acne (not to pick at face, keep up good hygiene, possibly healthy diet) 3. Explain sign and symptoms of acne and when to see resolution/alleviation	All key points covered	3 key points were covered from 4 point	2 key points were covered from 4 point	Improper Recommendation

Overall Performance	Superior(O+FS)	Good(G/A +FS)	Fair(A +MS/MU)	Need to improve(U+MU/U)